Intune MDM Home Lab – Glossary

Short definitions to explain the lab in an interview, with the day where each topic is covered.

Lab foundation (Day 1)

Topic	Short definition
Virtual machine (VM)	A computer running as software inside another computer; here the "employee laptop".
Snapshot	A save point of the VM you can return to; it keeps every change since, so it uses disk space.
UEFI / Secure Boot	Modern firmware; Secure Boot only lets trusted start-up programs run before Windows.
TPM 2.0	A security chip that stores keys (BitLocker, Windows Hello) and checks the startup wasn't tampered with.

Tenant and identity (Days 2–3)

Topic	Day	Short definition
Tenant	2	The company's private space in Microsoft's cloud (`<name>.onmicrosoft.com`).
Microsoft 365 admin center	2	Portal for licenses, billing and trials ("money office").
Entra admin center	2	Portal for identity: users, groups, sign-in, Conditional Access ("ID card office").
Intune admin center	2	Portal for devices: enrollment, policies, apps ("laptop office").
Microsoft Entra ID	2	Microsoft's cloud identity service (formerly Azure AD): who the user or device is.
MFA	2	Sign-in needs a second proof (e.g. Authenticator), so a stolen password alone is useless.
MDM authority	2	Which service manages devices in the tenant – here Microsoft Intune.
License	3	A per-user "work permit" for a service (e.g. Intune Plan 1, Entra ID P2).
Entra ID P1 / P2	3	Premium identity: P1 adds Conditional Access and dynamic groups; P2 adds risk-based protection and PIM.
M365 Business Premium / E3 / E5	3	Common bundles; Business Premium and E3 include Intune + Entra P1, E5 adds Entra P2 and more security.
Security group	3	A group used to target policies and permissions.
Assigned group	3	Members added by hand.
Dynamic group	3	Members added automatically by a rule (e.g. every Windows device).

Enrollment (Day 4)

Topic	Short definition
Enrollment	Bringing a device under management so Intune can apply policies and apps.
Entra join	The device belongs to the company; users sign in with company accounts. Ownership: Corporate.
Entra registration	A personal device with a work account added; limited control. Ownership: Personal (BYOD).
Automatic enrollment (MDM user scope)	Setting that hands every company-joined Windows device to Intune.
Primary user	The user Intune associates with the device.
Check-in / Sync	The device contacting Intune to get new policies and report status; Sync forces it now.
`dsregcmd /status`	Windows command showing the device's join state and sign-in token.
Windows Autopilot	Devices registered by hardware hash join and enroll themselves during Windows setup (concept covered; hands-on planned).
Apple Business Manager / ADE	Apple's equivalent: company-bought devices enroll into the MDM automatically.

Compliance (Day 5)

Topic	Short definition
Compliance policy	A checklist for a safe device; Intune only checks and reports (Compliant / Not compliant).
Default Device Compliance Policy	Built-in checks: policy assigned, device active, user still exists.
Noncompliance action / grace period	What happens when a device fails, and how long the user has to fix it.
Validity period	Days a device may go without checking in before it becomes Not compliant.
Device Health Attestation	TPM-signed startup report used to verify Secure Boot (doesn't work with VirtualBox's virtual TPM).

Configuration (Day 6)

Topic	Short definition
Configuration profile	A policy that changes settings on the device (compliance checks, configuration changes).
Settings catalog	Searchable list of thousands of Windows settings to build profiles.
Administrative templates	Settings that come from classic Group Policy.
Endpoint security	Intune area with ready-made security forms (disk encryption, baselines, firewall, LAPS).
BitLocker	Full-disk encryption; a stolen laptop's data stays unreadable.
Silent encryption	BitLocker turned on without asking the user (TPM unlock, no pop-ups).
Recovery key escrow	Saving the BitLocker recovery key in Entra/Intune before encrypting.
Security baseline	Microsoft's pre-made pack of recommended security settings.
Conflict	Two profiles set the same setting to different values; neither applies.
Included / Excluded groups	Who gets a policy / who is skipped even if included elsewhere.
Windows Hello PIN	Device-bound sign-in PIN stored in the TPM; works only on that laptop.
UAC	Windows' "allow this app to make changes?" prompt before admin actions.

Conditional Access and apps (Day 7)

Topic	Short definition
Security defaults	Microsoft's free all-or-nothing protection (MFA for all); can't run with Conditional Access.
Conditional Access (CA)	IF-THEN sign-in rules: who, which app, which device → allow, block or require MFA.
Require compliant device	CA grant that lets only Intune-compliant devices reach company apps.
Report-only mode	CA logs what it would do without blocking – used to test safely.
Sign-in logs	Entra record of every sign-in with CA and Report-only results.
Break-glass account	Emergency admin excluded from all CA policies.
SSO	Signed in once on the device, signed in to company apps automatically.
Company Portal	Microsoft's company app shop: approved apps, device status, IT contact.
Required / Available / Uninstall	Install automatically / user chooses in Company Portal / remove.
Microsoft Store app (new)	App type that delivers Store apps through Intune.
Win32 app	Intune app type for normal Windows installers, packaged as `.intunewin`.
IntuneWinAppUtil	Microsoft's tool that wraps an installer into `.intunewin`.
Install / uninstall command	Silent command Intune runs to install or remove the app (e.g. `/S`).
Detection rule	How Intune checks the app is installed (e.g. a file exists).
Intune Management Extension	Agent on the device that installs Win32/Store apps and runs scripts.
Enrollment restrictions	Rules limiting which devices may enroll (e.g. block personal devices).

Updates and lifecycle (Day 8)

Topic	Short definition
Update ring	Schedule for Windows updates (pilot first, everyone later).
Quality vs feature update	Monthly security fixes vs the big yearly Windows upgrade.
Feature update policy	Keeps devices on one chosen Windows version.
Deadline	Date after which Windows forces the update and restart.
Remote actions	Sync, Restart, Retire, Wipe, Fresh Start – sent from Intune to the device.
Retire	Removes company data and apps only (personal devices).
Wipe	Factory reset (company devices returned, lost or stolen).
Fresh Start / Autopilot Reset	Reinstall or reset while staying enrolled.
Offboarding	Block sign-in + revoke sessions → wipe device → remove licenses.
Revoke sessions	Ends sessions already signed in, not just new sign-ins.
Onboarding	New user signs in; group-assigned policies and apps arrive automatically.

Troubleshooting (Day 9)

Topic	Short definition
Event Viewer – DeviceManagement log	Device log showing each policy applied, warned or failed.
MDM diagnostic report	Full management report exported from Access work or school.
IME logs	Intune Management Extension logs for Win32/Store app installs.
Device actions report	Intune list of remote actions and their status.
Encryption report	Intune overview of BitLocker state per device.

Planned next

Topic	Short definition
Windows LAPS	Intune rotates and stores a random local admin password per device.
Scripts and remediations	PowerShell pushed from Intune (like JumpCloud commands).